

AI IN CONTENT CREATION AND MISINFORMATION

When AI-generated media enters
real communication systems

LIN Jiaxun: 25458922
ZHANG Yufei: 25405381
WU Jiaqian: 25428810
SHAO Shiqi: 25414372

Presentation Roadmap

From one robocall to a wider
misinformation system

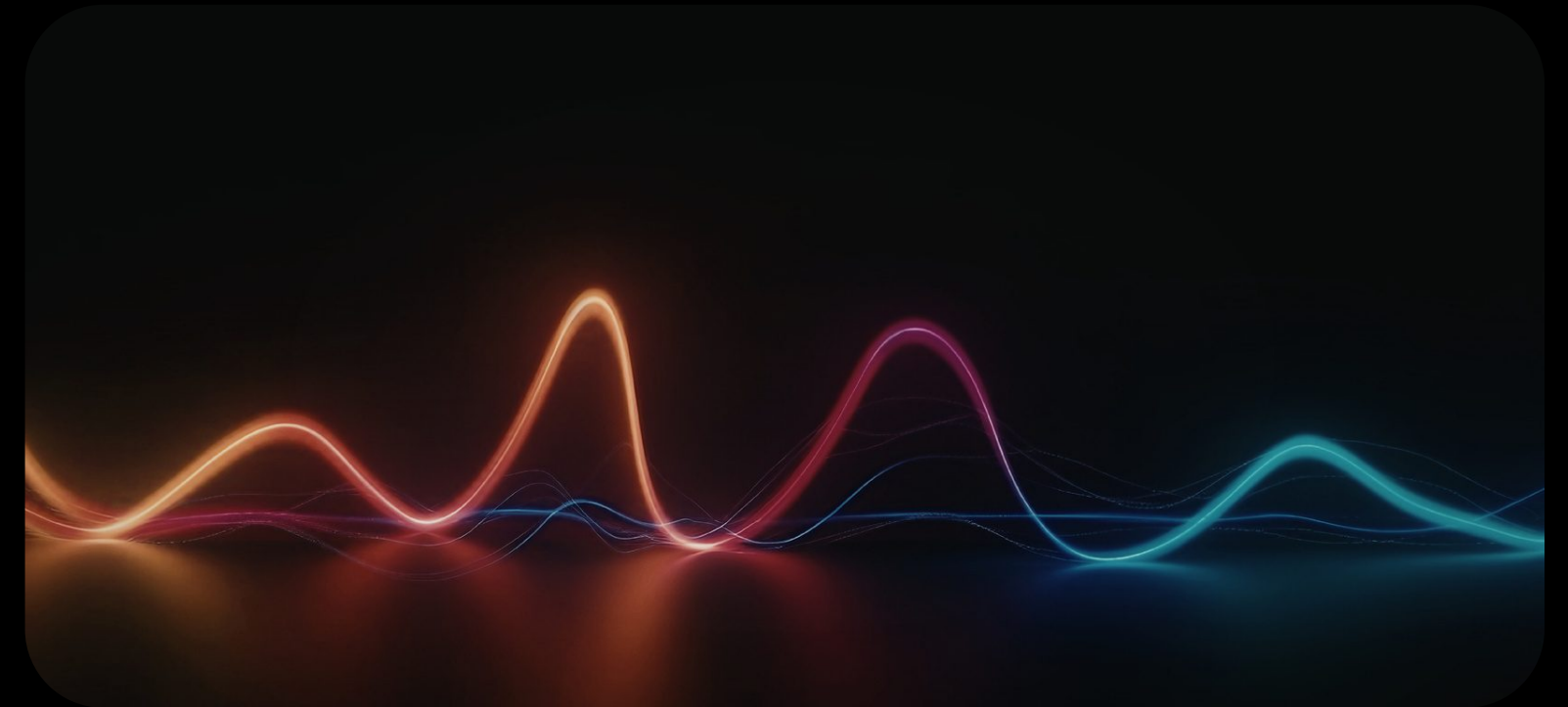
- The case
- The concepts behind it
- How media and research frame the issue
- Why the harm goes beyond belief
- What response should look like

Part 1 — The Case

The Case

A cloned voice in a real election

- January 2024
- New Hampshire voters received robocalls
- The voice resembled Joe Biden
- The message urged people to “save” their vote for November





What made the call persuasive?

Authority, routine, and timing

- Familiarity of voice
- Ordinary communication channel
- Strategic timing
- The deception worked because it sounded normal enough at a critical moment



Why this case matters

More than a rumor or a prank

- Direct link to real-world harm
- A documented event with public and regulatory response
- A strong case for studying AI, elections, and media trust
- Narrow enough to explain, broad enough to analyze

The case becomes a system story

Jan 2024

The deception
begins

Feb 2024

It becomes a policy
issue

Mid-late 2024

Enforcement follows

2025

Legal complexity
continues

The case moves
from incident to
governance
problem

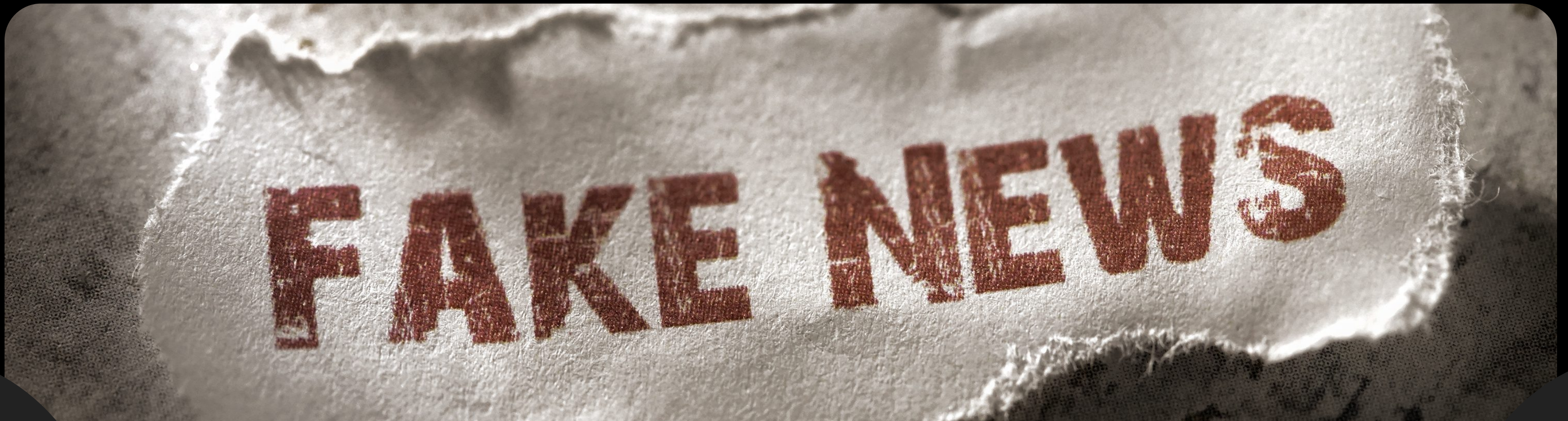


Part 2 — The concepts behind it



Key Concepts

- Why did a short fake audio message matter?
- Why was it effective without being visually dramatic?
- Why is this not only a “fake content” problem?
- This leads from the event itself to the concept framework



Key Concepts

Synthetic media, deepfakes,
and procedural deception

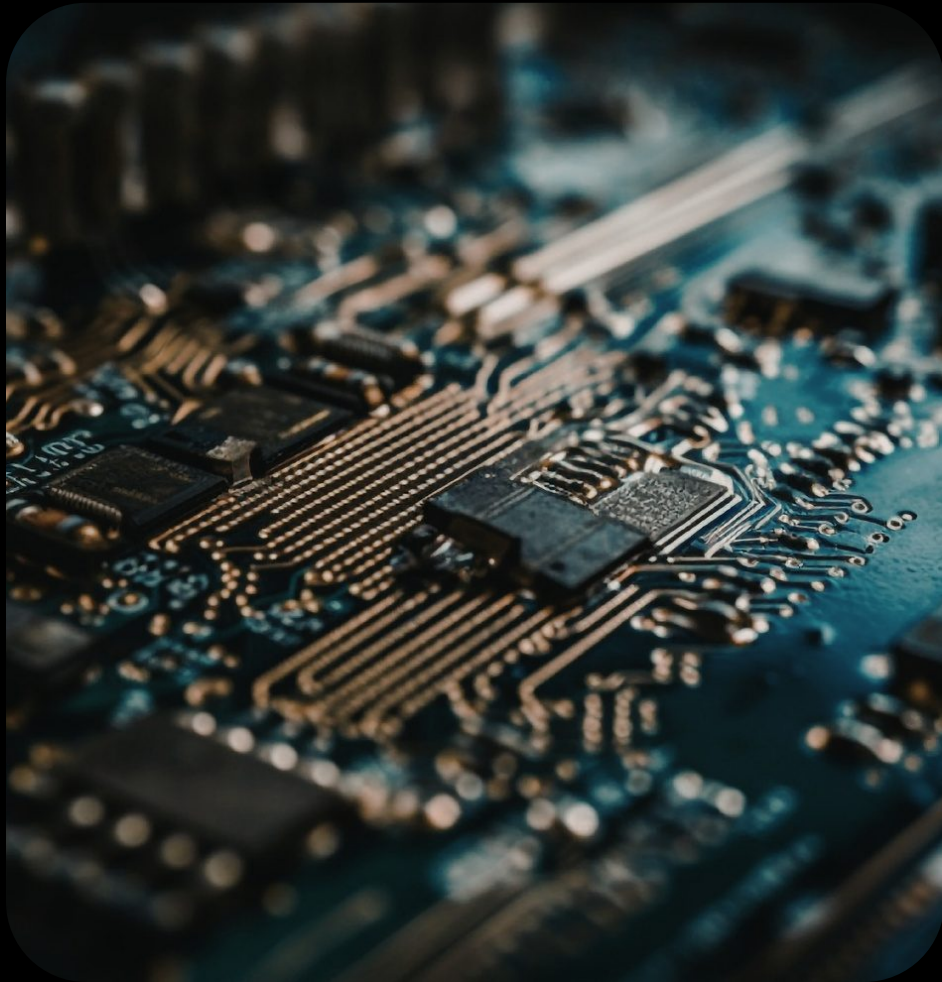
- Synthetic media: AI-generated or altered content
- Deepfakes: media that misrepresent what a real person said or did
- Procedural misinformation: false guidance about process, timing, or participation
- This case targets voting procedure, not only political opinion

Why this case is different

Not all misinformation is ideological

- It did not need a long political argument
- It gave misleading administrative guidance
- It redirected civic participation itself
- The harm came through procedure and timing





Voice cloning and infrastructure

A content problem and a systems problem

- Voice cloning lowers the barrier to impersonation
- Short samples can now produce plausible fake audio
- Telecom systems can scale misleading messages
- Caller ID spoofing and automated delivery increase credibility
- The message borrowed trust from both voice and infrastructure

Trust erosion and the liar's dividend

The long-term cost of synthetic media

- One fake can weaken confidence in future communication
- People may begin doubting genuine recordings
- Awareness of fakes can help bad actors deny real evidence
- Detection alone cannot solve this trust problem





Part 3 — How media and research frame the issue

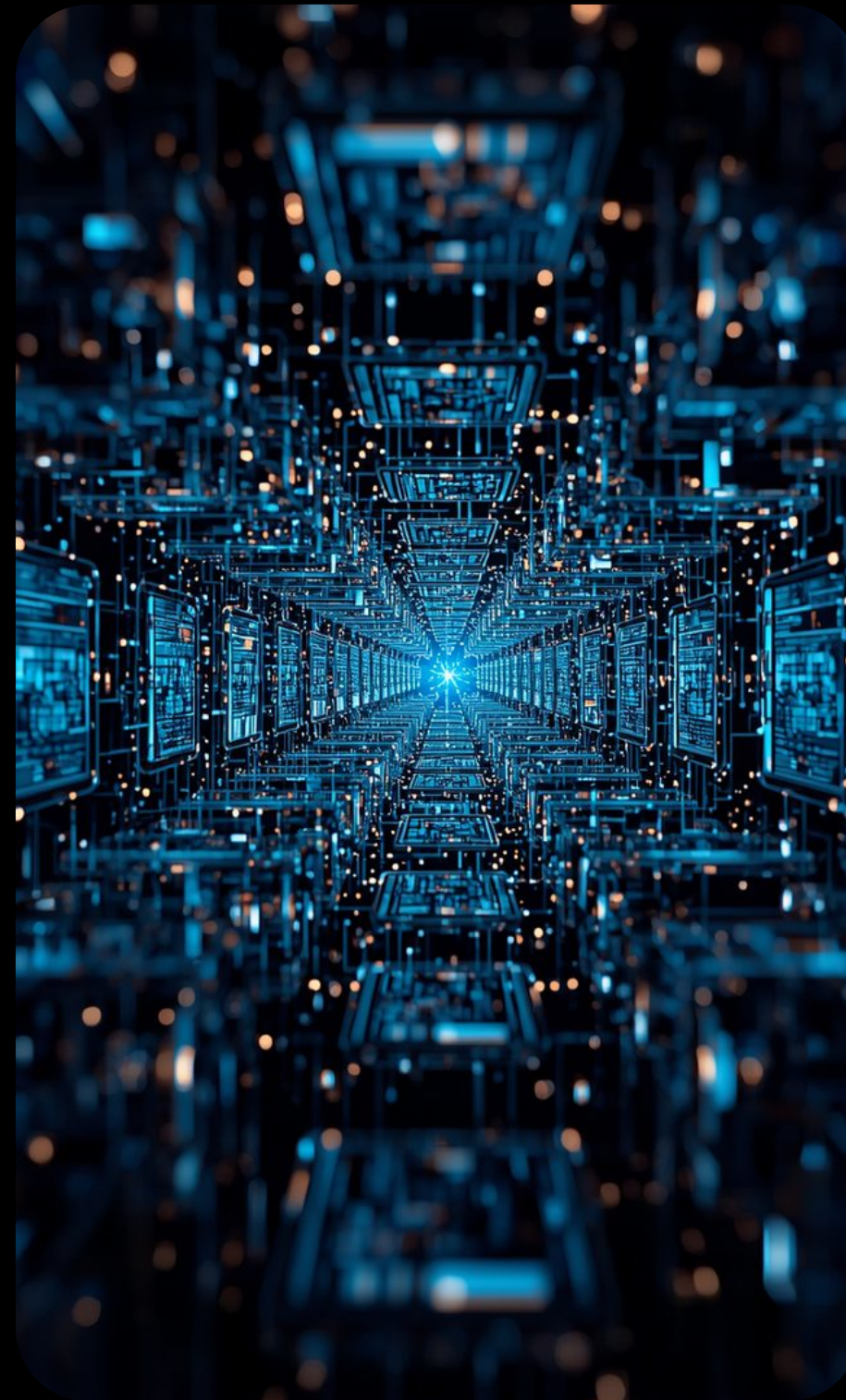


Framing the Issue

So how is this issue understood in public discussion ?

- News reports frame the event in one way
- Academic research explains it in another
- Together, they show why this is not an isolated case
- From concepts, we move to framing





Media Framing

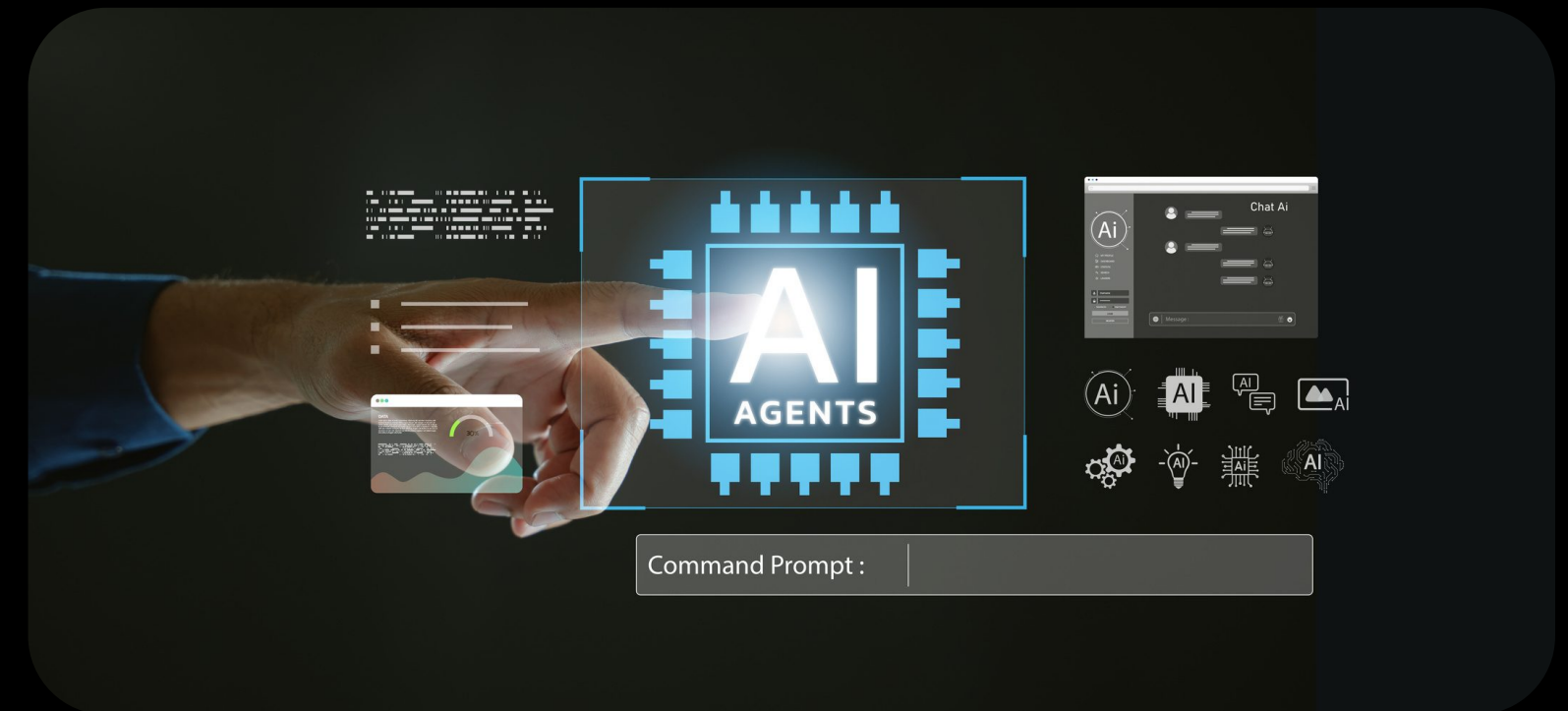
What the news emphasized

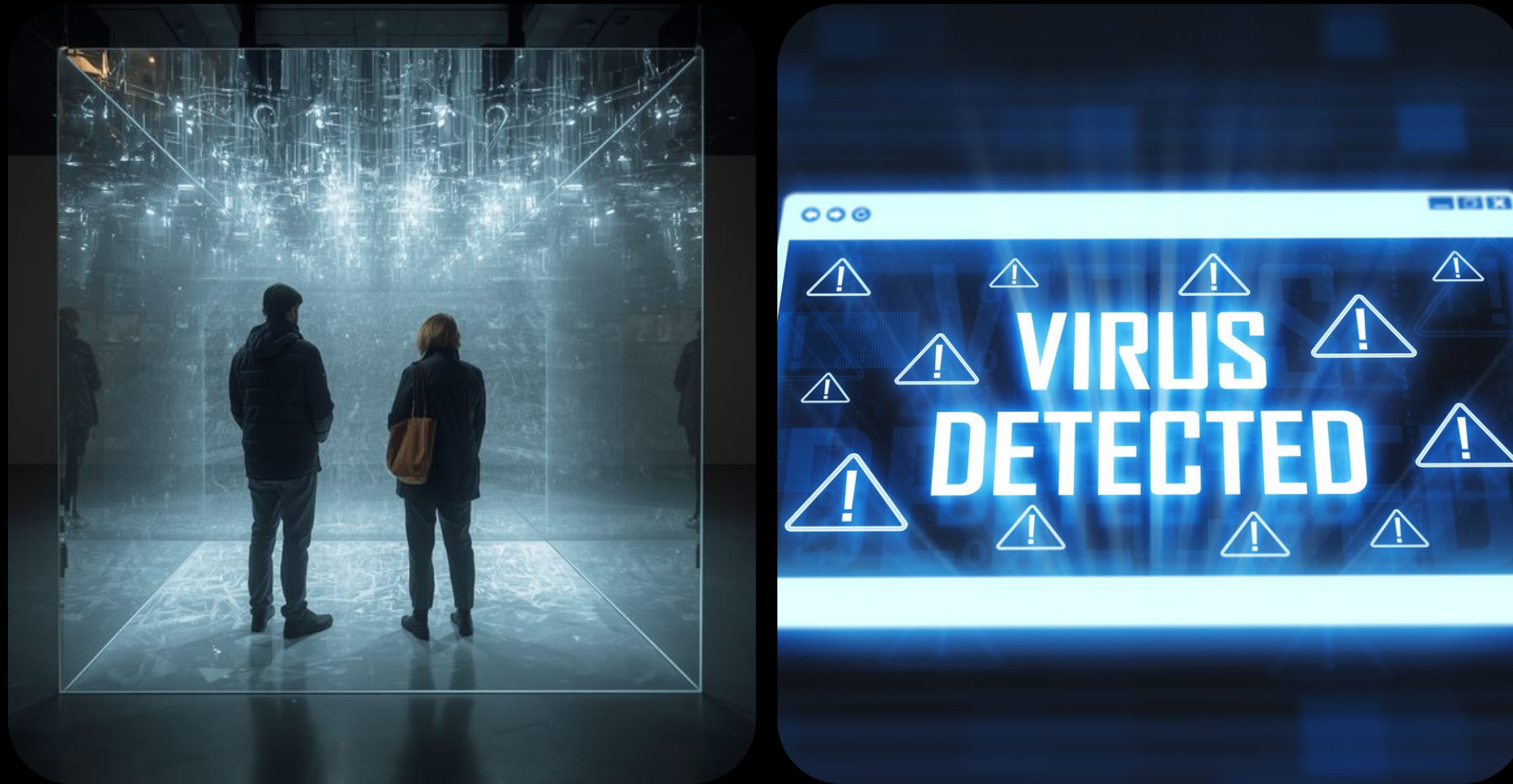
- Breaking political event
- Regulation and accountability
- Future risk to elections and democratic trust
- Media coverage turns one event into a warning sign

Research Framing

What existing scholarship helps explain

- People are poor at identifying AI-generated political media
- Low-attention settings make detection harder
- Debunking does not fully restore trust
- The key concerns are discernment, credibility, trust, and governance





- Detection is unreliable in everyday use
- Even exposed fakes can still damage trust
- The challenge is social as well as technical
- Regulation, infrastructure, journalism, and literacy all matter

Three key ideas from the literature

Why this project focuses on trust, not only detection



Part 4 — Why the harm goes beyond belief





Impact

- The key question is not only: “Did people believe it?”
- The bigger question is: “What does this do to trust?”
- The impact spreads across individuals, society, and institutions

Beyond “did people believe it?”

Individual level

False sense of
closeness and
credibility

Bypassing
rational scrutiny

Real-world
consequences
for participation

Synthetic audio
feels personal,
immediate, and
persuasive

Social and institutional impact

Social level

erosion of credibility, wider distrust in communication, undermining civic dialogue

Institutional level

disruption of normal operations, resource depletion, erosion of trust in democratic systems

The cost of synthetic misinformation spreads outward

Common misconceptions

Why the problem is often
underestimated

- Myth: If it sounds real, it is real
- Myth: Only viral misinformation matters
- Myth: Once exposed, the harm is over
- Targeted, temporary, and later-corrected misinformation can still do lasting damage



Part 5 — What response should look like

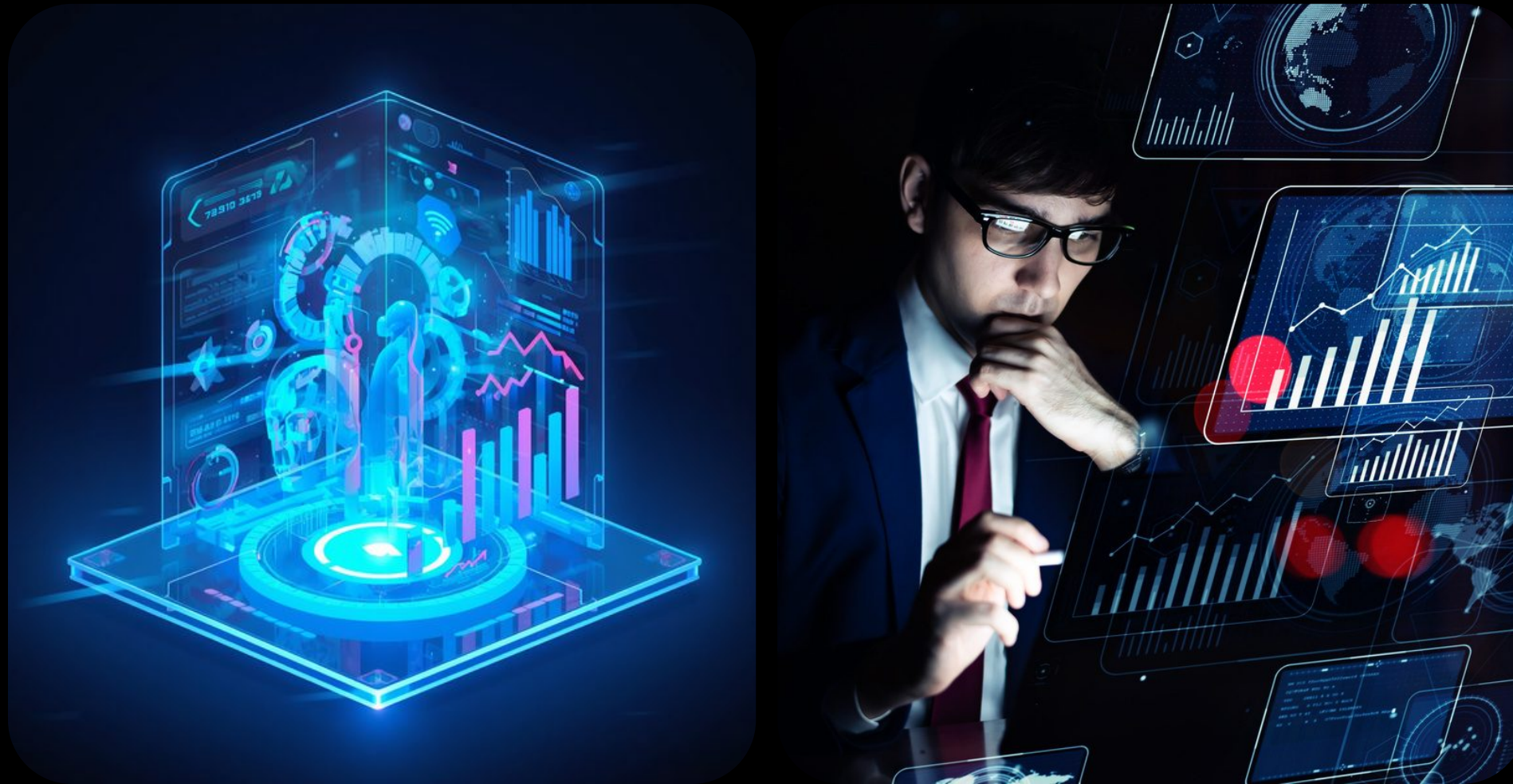




Response

If the harm is layered, the response must be layered too

- Users alone cannot solve the problem
- Better detection alone cannot solve the problem
- Response must work across people, platforms, and institutions



Response for users

Verify before trusting

- Treat surprising audio as a prompt to verify
- Check official sources before acting
- Be cautious with urgent or emotional messages
- Use multiple reliable sources, not one channel alone

Response for platforms and media

Label, trace, and correct

- Improve labeling and provenance signals
- Build rapid correction systems
- Prioritize elections and emergencies
- Explain harm without amplifying confusion





Response for policy and governance

- Clarify responsibility across creators, distributors, and infrastructure providers
- Build faster reporting pathways for political misinformation
- Support AI-era media literacy
- Recognize that technical detection alone is not enough



Thank you for listening



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